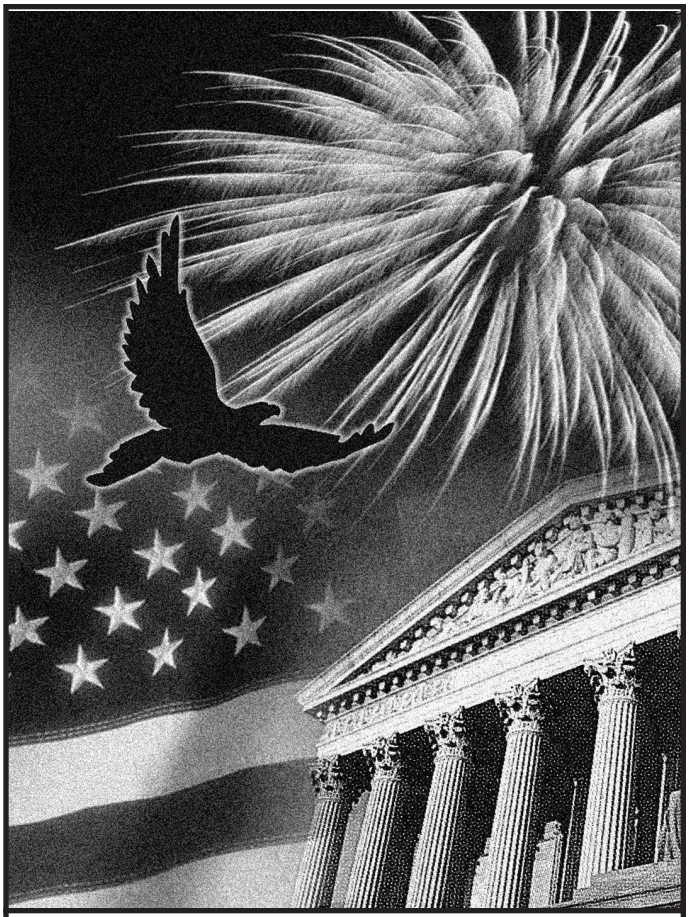
IRS

Publication 926

Household Employer's Tax Guide

For use in **2025**



Get forms and other information faster and easier at:

- *IRS.gov* (English)
- *IRS.gov/Spanish* (Español)
- *IRS.gov/Chinese* (中文)
- *IRS.gov/Korean* (한국어)
- *IRS.gov/Russian* (Русский)
- *IRS.gov/Vietnamese* (Tiếng Việt)

Contents

What's New 1

Reminders 2

Introduction 3

Do You Have a Household Employee? 3

Can Your Employee Legally Work in the United States? 4

Do You Need To Pay Employment Taxes? 4
- Social Security and Medicare Taxes 4
- Federal Unemployment (FUTA) Tax 7

Do You Need To Withhold Federal Income Tax? 9

What Do You Need To Know About the Earned Income Credit? 9

How Do You Make Tax Payments? 10

What Forms Must You File? 10

Forms in Spanish 11

What Records Must You Keep? 11

Can You Claim a Credit for Child and Dependent Care Expenses? 12

How Can You Correct Schedule H? 12

How To Get Tax Help 13

Index 18

Future Developments

For the latest information about developments related to Pub. 926, such as legislation enacted after it was published, go to *IRS.gov/Pub926*.

What's New

Social security and Medicare taxes for 2025. The social security tax rate is 6.2% each for the employee and employer. The social security wage base limit is $176,100.

The Medicare tax rate is 1.45% each for the employee and employer, unchanged from 2024. There is no wage base limit for Medicare tax.

Social security and Medicare taxes apply to the wages of household workers you pay $2,800 or more in cash wages in 2025. For more information, see *Cash wages*, later.

The COVID-19 related credit for qualified sick and family leave wages is limited to leave taken after March 31, 2020, and before October 1, 2021, and may no longer be claimed on Schedule H (Form 1040). The time periods for providing the leave for the credits for qualified sick and family leave wages, as enacted under

Publication 926 (2025) Catalog Number 64286A

Dec 17, 2024 Department of the Treasury **Internal Revenue Service** www.irs.gov

Table 1. **Do You Need To Pay Employment Taxes?**

IF you ...		THEN you need to ...
A	Pay cash wages of $2,800 or more in 2025 to any one household employee. Don't count wages you pay to: • Your spouse, • Your child under the age of 21, • Your parent (see *Wages not counted*, later, for an exception), or • Any employee under the age of 18 at any time in 2025 (see *Wages not counted*, later, for an exception).	Withhold and pay social security and Medicare taxes. • The taxes are 15.3%[1] of cash wages. • Your employee's share is 7.65%.[1] (You can choose to pay it yourself and not withhold it.) • Your share is 7.65%.
B	Pay total cash wages of $1,000 or more in any calendar quarter of 2024 or 2025 to household employees. Don't count wages you pay to: • Your spouse, • Your child under the age of 21, or • Your parent.	Pay FUTA tax. • The tax is 6% of cash wages. • Wages over $7,000 a year per employee aren't taxed. • You may also owe state unemployment tax.

[1] In addition to withholding Medicare tax at 1.45%, you must withhold a 0.9% Additional Medicare Tax from wages you pay to an employee in excess of $200,000 in a calendar year. You're required to begin withholding Additional Medicare Tax in the pay period in which you pay wages in excess of $200,000 to an employee and continue to withhold it each pay period until the end of the calendar year. Additional Medicare Tax is only imposed on the employee. There is no employer share of Additional Medicare Tax. All wages that are subject to Medicare tax are subject to Additional Medicare Tax withholding if paid in excess of the $200,000 withholding threshold.

Note. If neither A nor B above applies, you don't need to pay any federal employment taxes. But you may still need to pay state employment taxes.

Table 2. **Household Employer's Checklist**

You may need to do the following things when you have a household employee.

When you hire a household employee:	☐ Find out if the person can legally work in the United States. ☐ Find out if you need to withhold and pay federal taxes. ☐ Find out if you need to withhold and pay state taxes.
When you pay your household employee:	☐ Withhold social security and Medicare taxes. ☐ Withhold federal income tax. ☐ Decide how you will make tax payments. ☐ Keep records.
By February 2, 2026:	☐ Get an employer identification number (EIN). ☐ Give your employee Copies B, C, and 2 of Form W-2, Wage and Tax Statement. ☐ Send Copy A of Form W-2 with Form W-3 to the SSA. Don't send Form W-2 to the SSA if you didn't withhold federal income tax and the social security and Medicare wages were below $2,800 for 2025.
By April 15, 2026:	☐ File Schedule H (Form 1040) with your 2025 federal income tax return (Form 1040, 1040-SR, 1040-SS, 1040-NR, or 1041). If you don't have to file a return, file Schedule H by itself.

for social security tax and 1.45% for Medicare tax) of the employee's social security and Medicare wages. Your employee's share is also 7.65% (6.2% for social security tax and 1.45% for Medicare tax). In addition to withholding Medicare tax at 1.45%, you must withhold a 0.9% Additional Medicare Tax from wages you pay to an employee in excess of $200,000 in a calendar year. You're required to begin withholding Additional Medicare Tax in the pay period in which you pay wages in excess of $200,000 to an employee and continue to withhold it each pay period until the end of the calendar year. Additional Medicare Tax is only imposed on the employee. There is no employer share of Additional Medicare Tax. All wages that are subject to Medicare tax are subject to Additional Medicare Tax withholding if paid in excess of the $200,000 withholding threshold. For more information on Additional Medicare Tax, go to *IRS.gov/ADMT*.

TIP *Generally, you can use Table 3 to figure the amount of social security and Medicare taxes to withhold from each wage payment.*

You're responsible for payment of your employee's share of the taxes as well as your own. You can either withhold your employee's share from the employee's wages or pay it from your own funds. If you decide to pay the employee's share from your own funds, see *Not withholding the employee's share*, later. Pay the taxes as discussed under *How Do You Make Tax Payments*, later. Also see *What Forms Must You File*, later.